

Yifan Zhao (赵一帆)

Fourth-year Undergraduate, Artificial Intelligence

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Guangzhou, China



EDUCATION

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou)

2023 – Jun. 2027

B.Eng. in Artificial Intelligence

Guangzhou, China

CGA: 3.4+; MCGA: 3.5+ (Top 30%). Expected graduation: June 2027.

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Sep. 2025 – Dec. 2025

Exchange Student, Department of Computer Science & Engineering

Hong Kong, China

TGA: 3.6+.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

APCyc: Property-Informed Design of Cyclic Peptides via Automated Cyclization

May 2026

Yifan Zhao*, Lang Qin*, Jintai Chen†

KDD 2026 AI4Sciences Track Poster

A target-aware de novo cyclic peptide generation framework that explicitly models cyclization sites and linkage types. APCyc expands the residue vocabulary and uses Bayesian posterior guidance to steer sampling toward cyclic peptides that satisfy multiple drug-relevant physicochemical property objectives.

RoboStressBench: Benchmarking VLM Robustness to Physical Visual Stress in Embodied Scenes

May 2026

Leyi Wu*, Yifan Zhao*, Jinjie Zhang*, Suzeyu Chen*, et al., Ying-Cong Chen†

arXiv preprint | Project Page | Code

A benchmark for evaluating VLM robustness to physical visual stress in embodied scenes. RoboStressBench organizes stressors from an inverse-graphics perspective across material, viewpoint, lighting, and geometry factors, enabling controlled analysis of recognition, reasoning, and planning behavior under realistic scene perturbations.

IPV-Bench: Benchmarking Image Protection Methods under Diverse Image-to-Video Generation Scenarios

Mar. 2026

Xiaofeng Li, Leyi Sheng, Yifan Zhao, Zhen Sun, Zongmin Zhang, Jiaheng Wei, Xinlei He†

Submitted to AAAI 2027 | arXiv preprint

IPV-Bench benchmarks image protection methods for image-to-video generation across five image domains and four generators, evaluating protection effectiveness, visual fidelity, and robustness to preprocessing.

* Equal contribution. † Corresponding author.

AWARDS

EgoCross Challenge – Global 1st Place in Both Tracks

Jun. 2026

Open-Source Track and Source-Limited Track, 1st Cross-Domain EgoCross Challenge

CVPR 2026 EgoVis Workshop

Team WFJ-KnowinEnvision. Code | Technical Report | Certificate

National Undergraduate Electronics Design Contest

Jul. 2025

Advanced to the National Finals, ranked approximately top 1.5% nationwide

China

ASC Student Supercomputer Challenge (ASC24)

2024

Second Class Prize, Intelligent Computing Track

Shanghai, China

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research interests broadly lie in **generative AI**, **AI for Science**, and **embodied AI**, with a growing foundation in **diffusion models**, **AI agent systems**, and related topics.

SKILLS

Programming

Python, C++

Systems & Tooling

Linux, Git, Bash, SSH, Tmux, LaTeX, Codex, PowerPoint

Languages

Chinese (native), English (fluent)